# CODES OF ETHICS AND CODES OF CONDUCT

**DUAL-CODE FOUNDATION → VALUES-TO-RULES TRANSLATION → CIVIL-SERVICE CONDUCT MAP → NEUTRAL ADVICE AND IMPLEMENTATION → CONFLICT MANAGEMENT LADDER → GIFT ASSET AND OUTSIDE-WORK**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

## 00 STAGE 00 — DUAL-CODE FOUNDATION

DUAL-CODE FOUNDATION | CENTRAL FOCUS | 1. DUAL-CODE FOUNDATION | (1) PUBLIC OFFICE CREATES ROLE DUTIES | (2) ETHICS NAMES GUIDING VALUES | (3) VALUES ORIENT INTENTION AND JUDGMENT | (4) CONDUCT IDENTIFIES RECURRING RISKS | (5) RULES SPECIFY ACTS AND PROCEDURES

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 1. Dual-code foundation
- [1] Public office creates role duties
- [2] Ethics names guiding values
- [3] Values orient intention and judgment

### MECHANISM

- [4] Conduct identifies recurring risks
- [5] Rules specify acts and procedures
- [6] Valid authority supplies enforcement
- [7] Due process disciplines sanctions
- [8] Learning reconnects rule and value

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → Aspiration and enforceability are complementary, never automatic synonyms.
- ANSWER USE → Use to open every distinction or model-code answer.
- MUST REMEMBER: A code of ethics states aspirational values and reasoning commitments; a...

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Aspiration and enforceability are complementary, never automatic synonyms.**

## 01 STAGE 01 — VALUES-TO-RULES TRANSLATION

VALUES-TO-RULES TRANSLATION | CENTRAL FOCUS | 2. VALUES-TO-RULES TRANSLATION | (1) CHOOSE CONSTITUTIONAL VALUE | (2) DEFINE ROLE-SPECIFIC MEANING | (3) MAP FORESEEABLE ETHICAL RISK | (4) SPECIFY REQUIRED OR BARRED ACT | (5) CREATE DISCLOSURE OR APPROVAL ROUTE

CENTRAL FOCUS → 2. Values-to-rules translation → [1] Choose constitutional value → [2] Define role-specific meaning → [3] Map foreseeable ethical risk

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 2. Values-to-rules translation
- [1] Choose constitutional value
- [2] Define role-specific meaning

### MECHANISM

- [3] Map foreseeable ethical risk
- [4] Specify required or barred act
- [5] Create disclosure or approval route
- [6] Assign records and ownership

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] State fair consequence
- [8] Review effects and loopholes
- VERDICT → A value becomes administratively usable through procedures without losing its purpose.
- ANSWER USE → Use for work-culture and institutional-design questions.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → A value becomes administratively usable through procedures without losing its purpose.**

## 02 STAGE 02 — CIVIL-SERVICE CONDUCT MAP

CIVIL-SERVICE CONDUCT MAP | CENTRAL FOCUS | 3. CIVIL-SERVICE CONDUCT MAP | (1) RULE 3 GENERAL CONDUCT | (2) RULE 5 POLITICAL ACTIVITY | (3) RULES 8-9 MEDIA AND CRITICISM | (4) RULE 11 OFFICIAL INFORMATION | (5) RULE 13 GIFTS

3. Civil-service conduct map → [1] Rule 3 general conduct → [2] Rule 5 political activity

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Civil-service conduct map
- [1] Rule 3 general conduct
- [2] Rule 5 political activity

### MECHANISM

- [3] Rules 8-9 media and criticism
- [4] Rule 11 official information
- [5] Rule 13 gifts
- [6] Rule 15 outside work

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Rule 18 property
- [8] Disciplinary rules enforce breach
- VERDICT → Cite the rule family safely; verify mutable thresholds in current notifications.
- ANSWER USE → Use for CCS conduct-rule applications.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Use for CCS conduct-rule applications.**

## 03 STAGE 03 — NEUTRAL ADVICE AND IMPLEMENTATION

NEUTRAL ADVICE AND IMPLEMENTATION | CENTRAL FOCUS | 4. NEUTRAL ADVICE AND IMPLEMENTATION | (1) CHECK CONSTITUTION AND LAW | (2) GATHER ACCURATE EVIDENCE | (3) GIVE CANDID OPTIONS | (4) DECLARE PERSONAL OR PARTY BIAS | (5) RECORD MATERIAL ADVICE

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 4. Neutral advice and implementation
- [1] Check Constitution and law
- [2] Gather accurate evidence

### MECHANISM

- [3] Give candid options
- [4] Declare personal or party bias
- [5] Record material advice
- [6] Receive lawful policy decision

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Implement without partisan favour
- [8] Escalate unlawful direction safely
- VERDICT → Neutrality protects professional candour before decision and loyal legality after it.
- ANSWER USE → Use for political-neutrality and Minister-civil servant questions.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Neutrality protects professional candour before decision and loyal legality after it.**

## 04 STAGE 04 — CONFLICT MANAGEMENT LADDER

CONFLICT MANAGEMENT LADDER | CENTRAL FOCUS | 5. CONFLICT MANAGEMENT LADDER | (1) IDENTIFY PRIVATE INTEREST | (2) CLASSIFY ACTUAL POTENTIAL APPARENT | (3) DISCLOSE BEFORE PARTICIPATION | (4) ASSESS MATERIALITY INDEPENDENTLY | (5) RESTRICT ACCESS IF NEEDED

5. Conflict management ladder → [1] Identify private interest → [2] Classify actual potential apparent

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. Conflict management ladder
- [1] Identify private interest
- [2] Classify actual potential apparent

### MECHANISM

- [3] Disclose before participation
- [4] Assess materiality independently
- [5] Restrict access if needed
- [6] Recuse reassign or divest

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Record reasons and controls
- [8] Review outcome and recurrence
- VERDICT → Disclosure starts management; it does not automatically cure a material conflict.
- ANSWER USE → Use for relatives, procurement and regulatory capture.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Disclosure starts management; it does not automatically cure a material conflict.**

## 05 STAGE 05 — GIFT ASSET AND OUTSIDE-WORK CONTROLS

GIFT ASSET AND OUTSIDE-WORK CONTROLS | CENTRAL FOCUS | 6. GIFT ASSET AND OUTSIDE-WORK CONTROLS | (1) GIFT MAY CREATE OBLIGATION | (2) HOSPITALITY MAY BUY ACCESS | (3) ASSETS MAY REVEAL INTEREST | (4) OUTSIDE WORK DIVIDES LOYALTY | (5) FUTURE JOB MAY DISTORT REGULATION

CENTRAL FOCUS → 6. Gift asset and outside-work controls → [1] Gift may create obligation → [2] Hospitality may buy access → [3] Assets may reveal interest

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 6. Gift asset and outside-work controls
- [1] Gift may create obligation
- [2] Hospitality may buy access

### MECHANISM

- [3] Assets may reveal interest
- [4] Outside work divides loyalty
- [5] Future job may distort regulation
- [6] Current rule fixes procedure

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Privacy limits over-disclosure
- [8] Inquiry distinguishes risk from guilt
- VERDICT → Control influence and appearance without guessing thresholds or presuming corruption.
- ANSWER USE → Use for close-option traps and conflict examples.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Control influence and appearance without guessing thresholds or presuming corruption.**

## 06 STAGE 06 — MINISTERS AND LEGISLATORS

MINISTERS AND LEGISLATORS | CENTRAL FOCUS | 7. MINISTERS AND LEGISLATORS | (1) MINISTER BEARS POLITICAL RESPONSIBILITY | (2) OFFICIAL AND PARTY RESOURCES SEPARATE | (3) PRIVATE INTEREST YIELDS TO PUBLIC DUTY | (4) CIVIL-SERVICE IMPARTIALITY PROTECTED | (5) MEMBER DECLARES RELEVANT INTERESTS

7. Ministers and legislators → [1] Minister bears political responsibility → [2] Official and party resources separate

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Ministers and legislators
- [1] Minister bears political responsibility
- [2] Official and party resources separate

### MECHANISM

- [3] Private interest yields to public duty
- [4] Civil-service impartiality protected
- [5] Member declares relevant interests
- [6] Ethics Committee examines complaint

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Committee recommends sanction
- [8] House acts through its procedure
- VERDICT → Political and House accountability can arise without collapsing into criminal conviction.
- ANSWER USE → Use for comparative public-functionary answers.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Political and House accountability can arise without collapsing into criminal conviction.**

## 07 STAGE 07 — ETHICS-OFFICE OWNERSHIP

ETHICS-OFFICE OWNERSHIP | CENTRAL FOCUS | 8. ETHICS-OFFICE OWNERSHIP | (1) MAINTAIN AUTHORITATIVE CODE | (2) ISSUE PLAIN GUIDANCE | (3) GIVE CONFIDENTIAL ADVICE | (4) TRAIN WITH SCENARIOS | (5) MANAGE REGISTERS

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Ethics-office ownership
- [1] Maintain authoritative code
- [2] Issue plain guidance

### MECHANISM

- [3] Give confidential advice
- [4] Train with scenarios
- [5] Manage registers
- [6] Receive or route complaints

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Report aggregate trends
- [8] Propose periodic revision
- VERDICT → A named owner turns a document into an operating ethics institution.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Second ARC and 2025 Q6(a).

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → A named owner turns a document into an operating ethics institution.**

## 08 STAGE 08 — FAIR ENFORCEMENT ROUTE

FAIR ENFORCEMENT ROUTE | CENTRAL FOCUS | 9. FAIR ENFORCEMENT ROUTE | (1) IDENTIFY VALID APPLICABLE RULE | (2) PRESERVE RELEVANT EVIDENCE | (3) GIVE NOTICE OF ALLEGATION | (4) DISCLOSE MATERIAL FAIRLY | (5) USE IMPARTIAL INQUIRY

CENTRAL FOCUS → 9. Fair enforcement route → [1] Identify valid applicable rule → [2] Preserve relevant evidence → [3] Give notice of allegation

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. Fair enforcement route
- [1] Identify valid applicable rule
- [2] Preserve relevant evidence

### MECHANISM

- [3] Give notice of allegation
- [4] Disclose material fairly
- [5] Use impartial inquiry
- [6] Reach reasoned finding

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Match sanction to gravity
- [8] Provide review or appeal
- VERDICT → Credible discipline requires both consequence and procedural justice.
- ANSWER USE → Use for sanction, Article 311 and workplace-enforcement analysis.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Credible discipline requires both consequence and procedural justice.**

## 09 STAGE 09 — LOOPHOLE AND CIRCUMVENTION TEST

LOOPHOLE AND CIRCUMVENTION TEST | CENTRAL FOCUS | 10. LOOPHOLE AND CIRCUMVENTION TEST | (1) LOOK BEYOND FORMAL RECIPIENT | (2) AGGREGATE CONNECTED BENEFITS | (3) CHECK RELATIVES AND INTERMEDIARIES | (4) TRACE BENEFICIAL OWNERSHIP | (5) TEST SUBSTANCE AGAINST PURPOSE

10. Loophole and circumvention test → [1] Look beyond formal recipient → [2] Aggregate connected benefits

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Loophole and circumvention test
- [1] Look beyond formal recipient
- [2] Aggregate connected benefits
- [3] Check relatives and intermediaries

### MECHANISM

- [4] Trace beneficial ownership
- [5] Test substance against purpose
- [6] Protect innocent explanation
- [7] Close ambiguity prospectively
- [8] Train from the near miss

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → Literal compliance cannot legitimise a scheme designed to defeat the rule.
- ANSWER USE → Use for split gifts, shell interests and messaging avoidance.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Conflict of interest, gifts, outside employment, post-retirement work...

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Literal compliance cannot legitimise a scheme designed to defeat the rule.**

## 10 STAGE 10 — ETHICAL-COMPETENCE CYCLE

ETHICAL-COMPETENCE CYCLE | CENTRAL FOCUS | 11. ETHICAL-COMPETENCE CYCLE | (1) NOTICE THE ETHICAL SIGNAL | (2) FIND GOVERNING NORM | (3) MAP STAKEHOLDERS AND BIAS | (4) GENERATE LAWFUL ALTERNATIVES | (5) SEEK ADVICE EARLY

CENTRAL FOCUS → 11. Ethical-competence cycle → [1] Notice the ethical signal → [2] Find governing norm → [3] Map stakeholders and bias

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. Ethical-competence cycle
- [1] Notice the ethical signal
- [2] Find governing norm
- [3] Map stakeholders and bias

### MECHANISM

- [4] Generate lawful alternatives
- [5] Seek advice early
- [6] Choose and record reasons
- [7] Escalate or remedy safely
- [8] Reflect and improve practice

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → Competence connects character, rule knowledge and practical judgment.
- ANSWER USE → Use for the 2019 institutional-measures PYQ.
- EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: State whether a rule is statutory, service-rule...

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: State whether a rule is statutory, service-rule...

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Competence connects character, rule knowledge and practical judgment.**

## 11 STAGE 11 — COMPLETE EXAMINER ANSWER SPINE

COMPLETE EXAMINER ANSWER SPINE | CENTRAL FOCUS | 12. COMPLETE EXAMINER ANSWER SPINE | (1) DEFINE BOTH CODES PRECISELY | (2) STATE INDIA'S EXISTING CONDUCT LAYER | (3) PRESERVE UNIMPLEMENTED ETHICS CAVEAT | (4) NAME ROLE-SPECIFIC RISKS | (5) TRANSLATE VALUES INTO PROCEDURES

CENTRAL FOCUS → 12. Complete examiner answer spine → [1] Define both codes precisely → [2] State India's existing conduct layer → [3] Preserve unimplemented-ethics caveat

### CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. Complete examiner answer spine
- [1] Define both codes precisely
- [2] State India's existing conduct layer

### MECHANISM

- [3] Preserve unimplemented-ethics caveat
- [4] Name role-specific risks
- [5] Translate values into procedures
- [6] Assign ownership and monitoring

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Add fair enforcement and review
- [8] Conclude prevention plus accountability
- VERDICT → The best answer joins aspiration, operational design and lawful consequence.
- ANSWER USE → Use for 2024 Q5(a), 2025 Q6(a) and original Mains practice.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The best answer joins aspiration, operational design and lawful consequence.**

## E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | 1. CODES AS AN INSTITUTIONAL SYSTEM, NOT A DOCUMENT | 2. A SPECTRUM RATHER THAN A WATERTIGHT BINARY | 3. THE SECOND ARC'S CIVIL-SERVICE PROPOSAL | PRECISE READING | 4. VALUES-TO-RULES TRANSLATION | THE REGULATORY DESIGN PROBLEM | 5. POLITICAL NEUTRALITY AND RESPONSIVE GOVERNMENT

### OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- 1. Codes as an institutional system, not a document pair
- 2. A spectrum rather than a watertight binary
- 3. The Second ARC's civil-service proposal: precise reading
- 4. Values-to-rules translation: the regulatory design problem

### ADVANCED DEBATE

- 5. Political neutrality and responsive government
- 6. Speech, media and information in the digital workplace
- 7. Conflict of interest: beyond disclose-and-recuse
- 8. Gifts, hospitality and beneficial ownership

### LEGACY / NUANCE

- 9. Legislatures: self-regulation and public legitimacy
- 10. Ministers: political accountability and procedural fairness
- 11. Advice, investigation and adjudication
- 12. Monitoring: gaming-resistant ethics metrics

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels